

Open Prosthetics

An ex-marine who served in Iraq started the openprosthetics.org project, an example of Open Design efforts. The project hopes to make access to advanced prosthetic designs universal

organic waste in about 100 days. For a thousand rupees, you can get Bada Khamba, a kitchen waste composter that can manage waste generated by a family of five. The product write-up claims that it is odour free and doesn't attract pests and flies.

Even better, anyone can hire a local potter, and clone Daily Dump's designs and run your own franchise. There is no royalty structure stopping you from doing so.

Bada Khamba was designed by Poonam Bir Kasturi, a graduate of NID. "Her passion is to demonstrate simple alternative practices in the cycle of production and consumption.", her TED bio reads, and with DailyDump, she wants to make composting a national habit.

"My interest is to try and change behaviour and creating a large centralised business is not the priority. So when you set such a goal, then you view traditional ideas of competition, market share, wealth etc. through new lenses. What do I have to lose? If I fail, they will all say, ha, these non-management types don't know how to read a balance sheet. But if composting becomes a national habit, without one large business house but lots of micro-enterprises, then the purpose of Daily Dump is well served."

Quite a few businesses that use Daily Dump's open source design, ex-Digit Asst. Editor Karan Manral runs Green Essentials, based in Taleigao, Goa which sells composting pots, herbal solutions and indoor plants. It's one of the dozen odd businesses that use Daily Dump's open



Express yourself with your toolbox

source design, which has a wide range of products.

Which brings us to Switchklick.com. It already has a dozen unique ideas that I've created. I have plenty more in my head, but not enough time. I think there is a market for geeky collectibles, CPU and RAM sticks can be fossilised in acrylic or transparent plastic, fashioned into key-chains. In the long run, I would like to come up with a recyclists cookbook, full of original and amazing ideas to make something new and unique and personalised out of junk. Many of these ideas will be simple to implement, while some will be good enough to be saleable.

Designs from Switchklick

Lantern: Made using parts from a desktop hard drive, a keyboard, and a candle light holder. It gives a mild hue when used with a candlelight. Will try to upgrade it to a USB-powered LED light to see if it's better.

Printer tray: A discarded printer tray can be use it to rest your laptop or netbook. Not only is it ergonomic, a ten degree angle between the surface of your table and your laptop is more than enough to provide ample ventilation for your CPU fan.

Bathroom Mirror: The HDD platter is shiny, and reflective. It can be used like a mirror.

Cup Holder: The hard disk block has solid grooves, it can be used as a cup holder. You won't have to worry about spilling your coffee again.

Accupuncture Keyboard Footrest: You need two keyboards

Brewtopia

No, the Beer is NOT free, but ex Red Hat employees let you customize the packaging, and it is a favourite drink at tech company parties



The raised keyboard makes it comfortable to type



Add the piece of junk you'd otherwise throw away...



...and it makes it easy to use

for your feet. Preferably mechanical keyboards, they make a loud clickety sound and feel really good!

In the meanwhile, the following five documentaries will change the way you consume:

- The Corporation
- Home
- Manufactured Landscapes
- Addicted to Plastic
- The Age of Stupid 

The author is a technology enthusiast and is actively involved with e-waste and recycling initiatives. He is an avid Digit reader and regularly contributes to our web site and magazine